



Product Requirements Document

In-House Payroll Management Platform

Field	Details
Version	0.1
Status	Initial Scope
Reference	Zoho Payroll
Personas	Product Admin, Organization Admin, Employee

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1. Product Overview

The goal is to build an in-house, multi-organization payroll management platform inspired by the core functionality and workflows of Zoho Payroll.

The platform will allow multiple organizations to operate independently while being managed from a central product layer. It supports three personas:

- Product Admin — manages the overall product, organizations, master data, and access.
- Organization Admin — manages organization-level employees, payroll configuration, and payroll runs.
- Employee — accesses only their own payroll-related information.

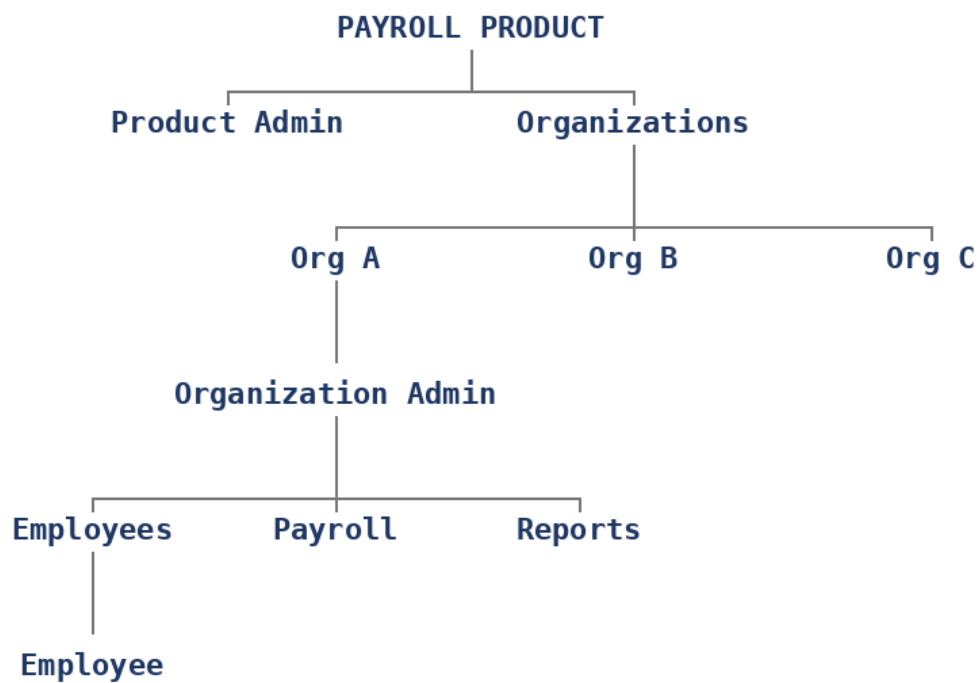
Initial focus flow:

Organization Management -> Access Management -> Employee Management -> Salary Setup -> Payroll Run -> Payslip -> Reports



2. Core Product Architecture

The system is multi-tenant — every organization's data must remain fully isolated from every other organization.





3. User Personas

Product Admin

Operates at the platform level. Responsibilities:

- Create and manage organizations
- Activate/deactivate organizations
- View product-level organization information
- Maintain product-level master data
- Manage Product Admin users
- Assign Organization Admin access
- Manage organization-level feature/access availability
- View platform-level audit logs

Access to sensitive employee payroll data should remain permission-controlled even for the Product Admin.

Organization Admin

Operates only within their assigned organization. An Organization Admin from Org A must never access Org B or Org C data.

- Manage employees
- Configure organization payroll settings
- Configure salary components
- Create salary structures/templates
- Assign employee salaries
- Add monthly payroll inputs
- Manage LOP, bonuses, and deductions
- Generate, review, and approve/finalize payroll
- Generate payslips
- View payroll reports
- Manage employee access within the organization

Employee

Self-service access only, limited strictly to their own information.

- View profile
- View salary structure
- View earnings and deductions
- View payroll history
- View/download payslips
- View LOP/payroll adjustments applicable to them



4. Access Management

Controls who can access what, and at which level, via role-based access.

Capability	Product Admin	Org Admin	Employee
Manage Organizations	Yes	No	No
Manage Product Masters	Yes	No	No
Assign Organization Admins	Yes	No	No
Manage Org Employees	Restricted	Yes	No
Configure Payroll	No / Restricted	Yes	No
Generate Payroll	No	Yes	No
Approve Payroll	No / Configurable	Yes	No
View Organization Reports	Restricted	Yes	No
Manage Employee Access	No	Yes	No
View Own Salary	-	If applicable	Yes
View Own Payslips	-	If applicable	Yes
View Other Employee Data	Restricted	Authorized	No

Access Management Functions

- User creation, role assignment, organization assignment
- Activate/deactivate user access; lock/unlock user
- Reset access/password
- Role-based menu visibility
- Backend permission validation
- Organization-level data isolation
- Employee-level self-access
- Access change history/audit log

Permissions must be enforced at both the frontend and API/backend level.



5. Organization Management

Product Admin creates and manages organizations. Basic organization details:

- Organization Name
- Organization Code
- Legal Name
- Address
- Payroll Country
- Financial Year
- Currency
- Organization Status

Possible statuses:

Draft -> Active -> Inactive -> Suspended

Every organization-specific record must be linked to an organization.

6. Employee Management

Organization Admin creates and maintains employees. Basic employee details:

- Employee ID
- Name
- Email
- Department
- Designation
- Date of Joining
- Employment Type
- Reporting Manager
- Work Location
- Employee Status
- Salary Information

Employees must belong to a specific organization.



7. Salary Management

The system supports configurable salary components.

Earnings

- Basic
- HRA
- Fixed Allowance
- Bonus
- Commission

Deductions

- PF
- ESI
- TDS
- Professional Tax
- LOP
- Other Deduction

Organization Admin defines a salary structure and assigns it to an employee. Example:

Component	Amount
Basic	Rs 30,000
HRA	Rs 15,000
Fixed Allowance	Rs 15,000
Monthly Gross	Rs 60,000

Salary structures should remain configurable instead of being permanently hard-coded.

8. Payroll Inputs

Each payroll month can contain additional employee-specific inputs:

- Bonus
- Incentive
- Commission
- One-time earning
- One-time deduction
- LOP
- Payroll adjustment

Example — July 2026:

Item	Value
Regular Salary	Rs 60,000
Bonus	Rs 5,000
Other Deduction	Rs 2,000
LOP	0 Days



9. Payroll Run

Organization Admin generates payroll for a selected payroll period (e.g. July 2026 Pay Run). The payroll engine considers:

Employee Salary Structure + Monthly Payroll Inputs + LOP + Applicable Deductions
-> Payroll Engine -> Gross Earnings -> Total Deductions -> Net Salary

The Organization Admin can review payroll at both organization level and individual employee level before finalization.

10. Payroll Workflow

Draft -> Calculated -> Under Review -> Approved -> Completed

Once payroll is completed, it is locked from direct modification. Future corrections happen through a controlled adjustment process rather than modifying historical payroll silently.

11. Payslips

After payroll completion, the system generates employee payslips containing:

Employee

- Employee ID
- Employee Name
- Payroll Period

Earnings

- Basic
- HRA
- Allowances
- Bonus
- Other Earnings

Deductions

- PF
- ESI
- TDS
- LOP
- Other Deductions

Summary

- Gross Earnings
- Total Deductions
- Net Pay

Employees should be able to securely view/download their own payslips.



12. Reports

Initial version reports for the Organization Admin:

- Payroll Summary
- Employee Payroll Report
- Earnings Report
- Deductions Report
- LOP Report
- Payslip Report

Reports should support basic filtering and export.

13. Audit & History

Sensitive payroll and access actions must be traceable. The system records:

- User
- Organization
- Action
- Date/Time
- Old Value
- New Value

Important audited events:

- Access changes
- Employee creation/update
- Salary changes
- Payroll input changes
- Payroll generation
- Payroll approval
- Payroll completion
- Payslip generation

14. Initial MVP Modules

Product Admin	Organization Admin	Employee
Dashboard	Dashboard	Dashboard
Organizations	Employees	My Profile
Product Masters	Salary Management	My Salary
Access Management	Payroll / Pay Runs	My Payroll
Audit History	Payslips	My Payslips
	Reports	
	Access Management	
	History	



15. Initial End-to-End Flow

Product Admin -> Create Organization -> Assign Organization Admin
-> Organization Admin -> Create Employees -> Configure Salary
-> Add Monthly Payroll Inputs -> Generate Pay Run -> Review Payroll
-> Approve -> Complete Payroll -> Generate Payslips
-> Employee -> View Own Payslip

16. Current Scope

Development focus for the current stage:

- 1. Multi-organization architecture
- 2. Three-persona authentication
- 3. Access Management
- 4. Organization Management
- 5. Employee Management
- 6. Salary Components and Salary Structure
- 7. Payroll Inputs
- 8. Payroll Run
- 9. Payroll Review and Approval
- 10. Payslip Generation
- 11. Basic Payroll Reports
- 12. Audit History

Out of scope for this phase: AI assistants, advanced tax workflows, reimbursements, loans, bank integrations, accounting integrations, configurable workflow builders, and advanced analytics.



Summary

The product is a multi-tenant payroll application built around three levels of access:
Product Admin -> Organization Admin -> Employee.

The Product Admin controls the platform and organizations. The Organization Admin manages employees and executes payroll for their organization. The Employee receives secure self-service access to their own payroll information.

Primary objective of the first phase:

Organization Setup -> Access -> Employee -> Salary -> Payroll -> Payslip -> Reports



Indicative MVP Timeline

Phase	Scope	Indicative Duration
1. Foundation & Design	Architecture, DB design, three-persona authentication, multi-tenant structure	3–4 days
2. Product Administration	Organizations, Product Masters, Access Management	4–5 days
3. Organization & Employee Setup	Org configuration, employees, salary components, salary structures	5–6 days
4. Payroll Core	Payroll inputs, LOP, earnings/deductions, payroll calculation, pay runs	7–8 days
5. Payroll Completion	Review, approval, locking, payslip generation	4–5 days
6. Reports & History	Basic reports, access/payroll audit history	3–4 days
7. QA & UAT	End-to-end testing, persona/access testing, payroll validation, fixes	4–5 days

Indicative MVP: approximately 5-6 weeks, assuming the current scope remains stable.